GUIDE 05 · START

Try it without any setup, using the built-in example APIs

The latest version is at anantharajuc.github.io/QueryAPIGate-website/Guide.dc.html?g=05-try-the-built-in-example-apis. This copy was made on 4 November 2026.

Time: 2 minutes to load, as long as you like to explore. **You'll end up with:** four realistic, fully-worked example APIs - reporting, a live dashboard, a bulk export, and a partner integration - each with its own scoped key, running against a small generated database. No external database, no config file to write by hand.

This is the fastest way to see what a finished, production-shaped setup looks like before building your own - real collections, real roles, real per-scenario API keys, real run history, not a placeholder.

Step 1: Load them

```shell
QUERYAPIGATE_API_KEY=demo-key queryapigate examples load
```

```text
Loaded the example APIs: 11 queries in 4 collections, 5 roles, and the 'examples' connection.
Example API keys (store these now - they cannot be shown again):
  example-dashboard: sk_...
  example-executive: sk_...
  example-export: sk_...
  example-partner: sk_...
  example-reporting: sk_...
Try:  queryapigate serve   then open /console, or  curl http://127.0.0.1:5000/q/example_top_films -H 'X-API-Key: <one of the secrets above>'
Watch it live:  curl -N http://127.0.0.1:5000/events -H 'X-API-Key: <one of the secrets above>' (then call a query in another terminal to see the event arrive)
Remove them again with:  queryapigate examples unload
```

Copy those five secrets somewhere now - like any API key, they're generated fresh and shown exactly once; there's no way to retrieve them again later, only to remove the keys and start over. Setting `QUERYAPIGATE_API_KEY=demo-key` first gives you an admin key too - the moment any key exists, the server requires one for every request, examples included.

```shell
QUERYAPIGATE_API_KEY=demo-key queryapigate serve
# Serving on http://127.0.0.1:5000
```

Running `examples load` again is safe and idempotent - "The example APIs are already loaded - nothing changed," no duplicates, no new keys generated. `queryapigate examples status` tells you the current state at a glance without changing anything.

What just got installed

A generated SQLite database (`examples` connection) - 8 tables with real foreign keys (`film` , `customer` , `rental` , `category` , `store` , `staff` , `address` , `payment`), 60 films, 200 customers, and 20,000 rentals dated relative to *today*, so "rentals so far today" and "overdue" queries always have something real to show, not stale fixture data.

Four collections, each shaped like a real scenario:

COLLECTION	SIMULATES	QUERIES
`examples-reporting`	A read-only, rate-limited reporting API	`example_monthly_revenue` , `example_top_films` , `example_revenue_by_category`
`examples-dashboard`	Small polled queries, cached 30s each	`example_kpi_rentals_today` , `example_kpi_active_rentals` , `example_kpi_overdue` , `example_recent_rentals`
`examples-export`	A bulk `?stream=true` export	`example_all_rentals` (~20,000 rows), `example_rentals_since`
`examples-partner`	A narrow, validated external-client surface	`example_film_lookup` , `example_film_search`

Five roles, and one real API key created from each - `example-reporting` , `example-dashboard` , `example-export` , `example-partner` (one per collection above, rate-limited to match what that kind of traffic would realistically need - e.g. `example-export` 's key is capped at 20 requests/hour, a bulk export isn't meant to be polled), plus a fifth, `example-executive` , granted *both* the reporting and dashboard collections at once - the one thing none of the other four shows on its own: a role reaching several collections together, not just one.

Seeded run history - each query already has realistic-looking (synthetic, clearly not real traffic) execution history, so the admin UI's History tab, Home tab and requests-per-day charts show something immediately instead of an empty state. This is the one part that's synthesized; live counters (`/metrics` , the Usage columns on API Keys/Connections) are never faked - those reset on restart and stay honest.

Step 2: Call one

shell

```
curl 'http://127.0.0.1:5000/q/example_top_films?top_n=3' -H 'X-API-Key: demo-key'
```

json

```
[{"title": "Electric Signal", "category": "Comedy", "rating": "PG", "rentals": 977, "rank": 1},
 {"title": "Electric Garden", "category": "Documentary", "rating": "PG", "rentals": 919, "rank": 2},
 {"title": "Distant Garden", "category": "Drama", "rating": "R", "rentals": 821, "rank": 3}]
```

Or use one of the scoped keys `load` just printed instead of the admin key - it only reaches its own collection:

shell

```
curl 'http://127.0.0.1:5000/q/example_top_films?top_n=3' -H 'X-API-Key: <the example-reporting secret>'
```

Try the bulk export too, streamed rather than paged (see Export a large result without running out of memory):

```shell
curl 'http://127.0.0.1:5000/q/example_all_rentals?stream=true&format=csv' -H 'X-API-Key: demo-key' |
head
```

Step 3: Explore it in the admin UI

Open http://127.0.0.1:5000/console. Two things worth noticing right away:

- **API Repository** shows a banner across the top: *"Example APIs are loaded: 11 queries in 4 collections, 5 roles and an 'examples' connection. Removing them touches nothing else."* - with a **Remove examples** button right there, the UI equivalent of `queryapigate examples unload`.
- Click any example query (e.g. `example_kpi_active_rentals`) and its **Run** tab already shows real numbers - total runs, success rate, average duration, a requests-per-day bar chart - from the seeded history above, with no need to call it yourself first.

From there, the same tabs work as they would for a query you wrote yourself: **SQL** (the query text), **History** (every run, seeded or real), **Curl/CLI** (copy-pasteable commands), **API Keys/Roles** (which of the five keys can reach this specific query), **Access**, **Cache** (for the dashboard scenario's `cache_ttl=30` queries), **Metrics**. Visit **Access map** (under **Access** in the sidebar) to see all five keys and every query they reach laid out at once - the fastest way to build intuition for how `connections` / `queries` / `collections` grants actually compose, before designing your own.

Removing them

```shell
queryapigate examples unload
```

```text
Removed 11 example queries, 5 roles, 5 API keys and the connection.
```

Removes exactly what was marked as an example - nothing you've added yourself, even if it happens to share a connection or collection name. Real data you connected in the meantime is untouched.

Next steps

- Turn your first SQL query into a REST API - the same walkthrough, but starting from a blank query instead of an example.
- Connect your own database once you're ready to move past the generated one.
- Verify who can reach what - the Access map, explored here against a known-good example setup first.
- Read the example APIs as a template for your own.